Experiment – 10

Schedules

Creating Scheduled Workflows in Zoho Creator

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Application Name: Purchase Request / Procurement Application

Objective

To configure a scheduled workflow in Zoho Creator that performs an action automatically at a selected date and time, repeats at a chosen interval, and sends an email notification related to purchase approval requests.

Introduction

A schedule is a workflow that runs according to time settings instead of being triggered by a user creating or editing a record. It can be used for reminders, periodic reports, and follow-ups. A schedule may run once or repeat daily, weekly, monthly, or yearly. It can also use a date field from a record as its trigger. When it runs, it can send an email or SMS, update records, or execute a Deluge script.

Schedule Requirements

This experiment demonstrates the Daily, Weekly, and Monthly repetition options. The required frequency is selected from the Run field when defining the schedule.

Frequency	Meaning	Example in this Application
Daily	Runs each day at the selected time	Reminder for purchase requests waiting for approval
Weekly	Runs weekly based on the start date	Summary of pending requests sent to the HOD
Monthly	Runs monthly on the corresponding date	Report on approved purchases and budget usage

Schedule Configuration

Setting	Value	Purpose
Schedule type	Specify Date and Time	Uses a fixed start time rather than a date field
Start date and time	20-Oct-2026, 21:00:00	Defines the first scheduled run
Run	Daily	Sets the repetition interval
Workflow name	Approval submission requezt	Name used to save the schedule in the application
Action type	Notification → Send email	Sends a notification when the schedule runs

Screenshot-Based Lab Record

The following screenshots illustrate the schedule setup in Zoho Creator.

Screenshot 1 – Schedules Tab

The Schedules tab lists the scheduled workflows. Before a schedule is created, the page is empty and provides an option to create a new workflow.

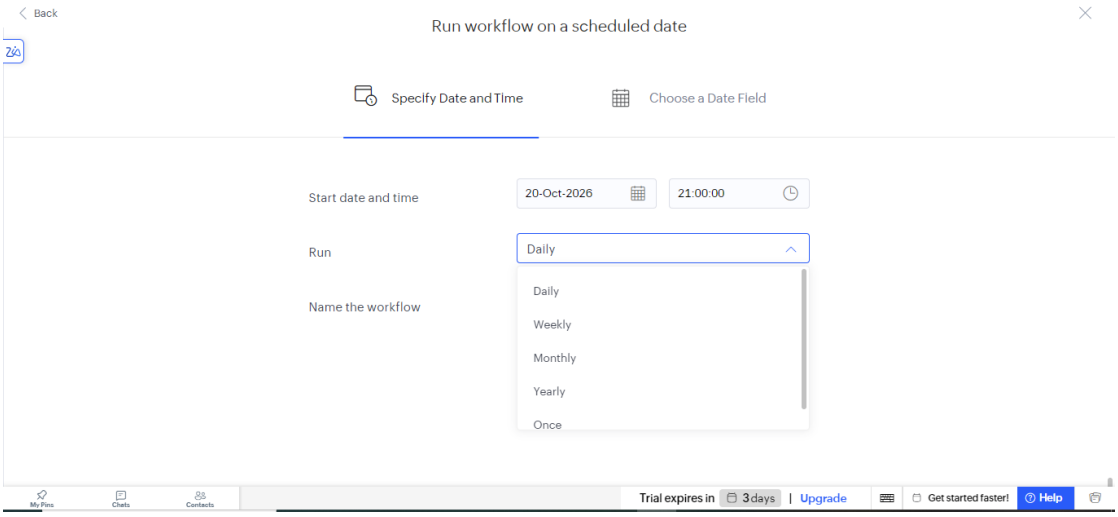


Figure 1: Schedules tab before a scheduled workflow is created.

Screenshot 2 – Creating the Schedule

The scheduled-workflow form offers Specify Date and Time or Choose a Date Field. The fixed date and time option was selected, and the start date, time, repetition interval, and workflow name were entered.

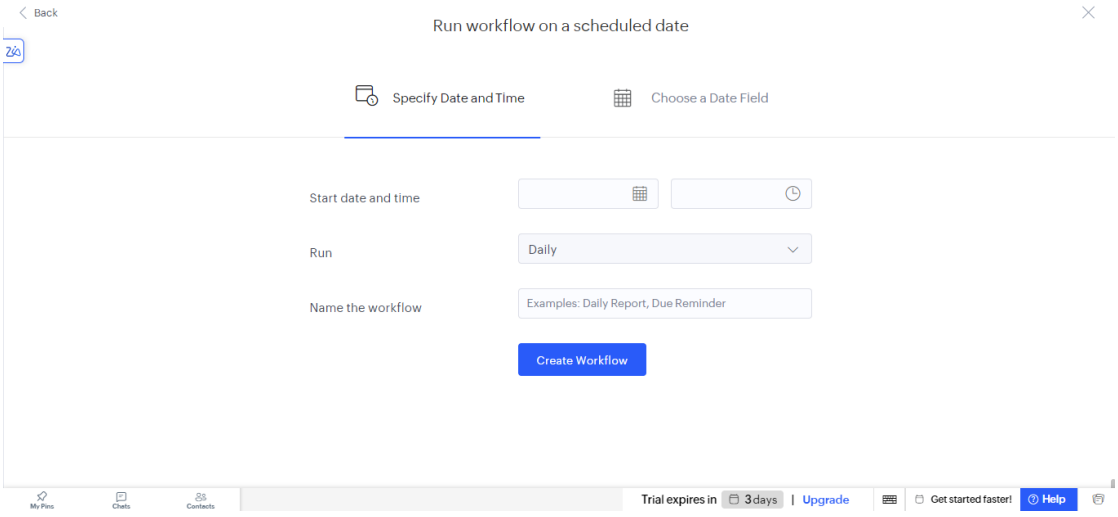


Figure 2: Scheduled workflow configuration with a fixed date and time.

Screenshot 3 – Selecting the Repetition Interval

The Run field provides Daily, Weekly, Monthly, Yearly, and Once options. Daily was selected for the configured workflow, while Weekly and Monthly are also available for the experiment.

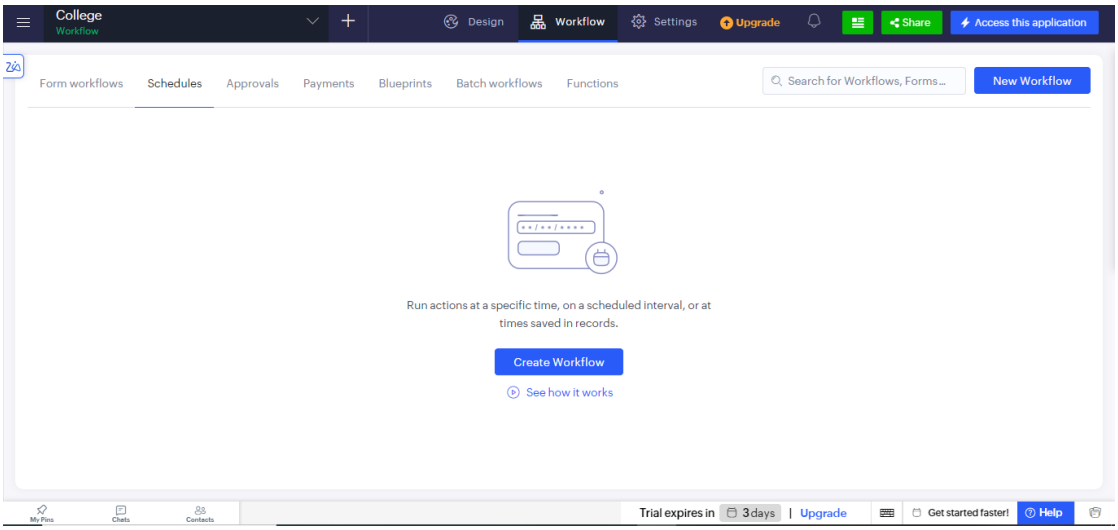


Figure 3: Run drop-down showing the available schedule intervals.

Screenshot 4 – Adding an Action

After the schedule is created, Add New Action allows a Notification, Data access, or Deluge script action to be added. Notification was selected to configure an email.

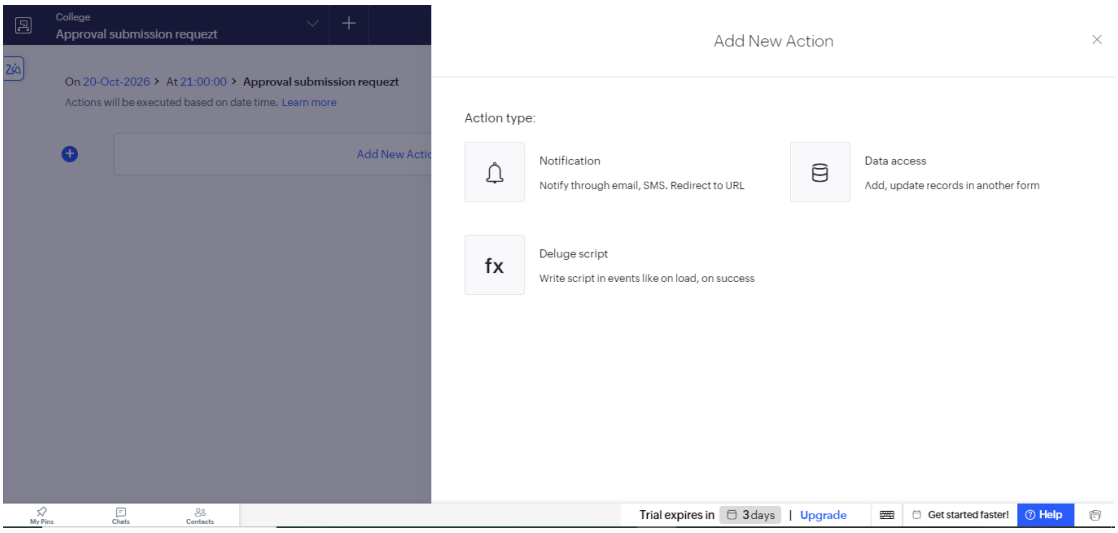


Figure 4: Add New Action panel for the scheduled workflow.

Screenshot 5 – Send Email Action

The Send email page allows the sender, recipient, subject, and message to be configured. Cc, Bcc, and Reply-to fields may also be added before saving the action.

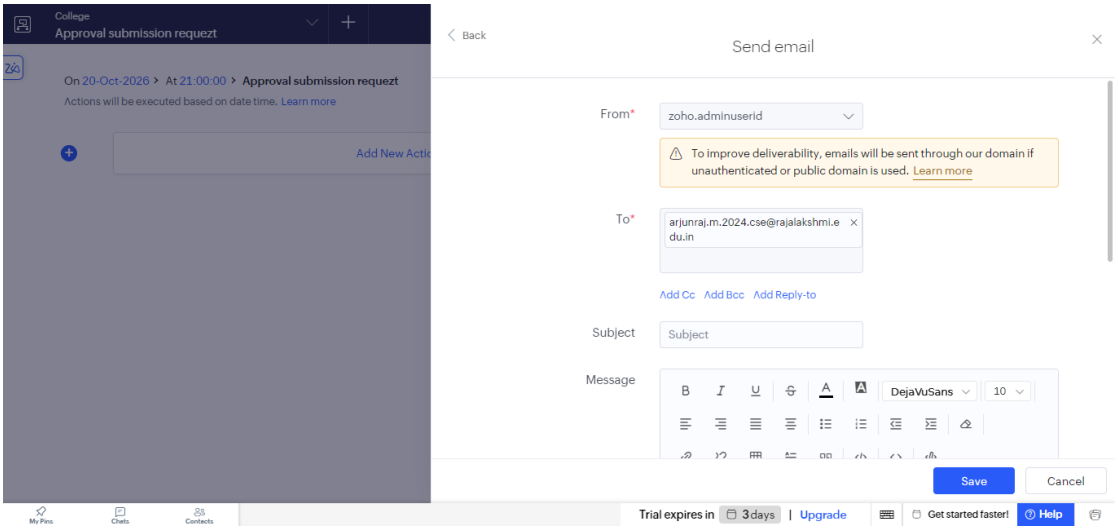


Figure 5: Send email action configured for the schedule.

Observation

The scheduled workflow was configured without writing code. Once the date, time, and repetition interval are specified, the attached action can run automatically. The Run setting can be changed to Daily, Weekly, or Monthly depending on the requirement. The Choose a Date Field option offers another approach by running actions based on a date stored in a record. Unlike a form workflow, which responds to a form event, or a Blueprint, which controls the next allowed process stage, a schedule is driven by time.

Result

A scheduled workflow named Approval submission requezt was configured in Zoho Creator with a start date of 20-Oct-2026 at 21:00:00, a daily repetition interval, and a Send email notification action. The configuration also supports the Weekly and Monthly intervals required for the experiment.